

Kingston

Has recently announced the inclusion of 8 GB and 16 GB cards to their range of microSD High-Capacity cards meant for mobile storage

Autodesk update

Autodesk Smoke and Flint 2010, software for editorial finishing and visual effects, now available in India along with Autodesk Lustre and Incinerator color grading software extension packs available to Autodesk subscribers

Bazaar

Iomega Prestige Portable 250 GB

Metal gear

Hard drive capacities continue to rise. The requirements of most people is still limited to moving data that wouldn't fit into flash drives. Now, customers want more than just capacity. Design and quality of the drive comes into the picture. The Iomega Prestige Portable 250 GB is a drive that seems to fit this gap.

The Iomega Prestige series drives come in brushed metal cases. It makes the drive really sturdy, but it isn't very heavy either at 190 grams. Although this is one of the premium drives from Iomega, there is no Firewire or any other faster connectivity options available.

Synthetic tests show that the Iomega drive is very capable of performing. We used SiSoft Sandra and all the read speeds hovered around

the 30 MBps mark which is pretty good for a portable drive. HD Tach too supported the same scores. The speeds are right on the edge of the peak performance of USB 2.0. CPU utilization numbers are pretty high at around 9 to 10 per cent through the tests.

In the real-world tests, the drive can write 4 GB sequential file rounds at around 24 MBps. Write speeds are around 20 per cent slower than read. Internal file copy commands take almost double the time which is expected from portable hard drives. Speeds while copying data from the portable drive to the internal one went up to 31.5 MBps which is really good as well.

When performance figures are compared, then the Iomega Prestige drive is at par with the faster drives

from the hard drive test in April. The price of Rs. 3,800 is pretty good as you aren't paying a lot more.



Contact

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Price: Rs. 3,800

Specifications

Capacity: 250 GB

Speed: 5400 rpm

Cache: 8 MB

Dimensions: 130.6 x 80 x 15.5 mm

Weight: 190 g

RATINGS

Features	7
Performance	8
Build Quality	8.5
Value for money	7.5
Overall	8

ASUS Bamboo U6V

Serious styling, decent performance

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd

Phone: +91-22-6766 8800 /
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Email: media_india@asus.com

Web site: www.asus.in

Price: Rs. 1,10,000

Specifications

Core 2 Duo P8600 @ 2.4 GHz

Display: 12-inch WXGA LED
backlight

Memory: 4 GB DDR II (2GBx2)

Graphics: NVIDIA 9300M GS
256MB

Weight: 1.57 kg

The lid of the ASUS Bamboo U6V is made of bamboo, which gives this laptop a unique artistic feel. Once you open the lid, the palm rest as well as the trackpad are both made of bamboo. Though there is a slight noticeable difference between the wood used on the palm rest and the trackpad.

The response of this trackpad wasn't great. Even the

buttons on the trackpad are made of bamboo, but they lack feedback. A USB mouse, also made of bamboo is included. The keys on the right of this keyboard, such as the arrow keys, get squished. The layout on the Dell Studio XPS 13, for example, is better. Of course, there are no unusable keys, and the keyboard feedback is decent.

The Bamboo comes with a bright 12-inch, 1280x800 WXGA LED backlit display. The viewing angles on this laptop

are not very good though.

With the Intel Core 2 Duo P8600, 4 GB of DDR2 memory and an NVIDIA 9300M GS graphics our benchmark results from PC Mark 05 (5141), 3D Mark 05 (3184), SiSoft Sandra, Cinebench (4662), Doom 3 (93 fps) and Far Cry (189.69 fps) were very promising. The Dell Studio XPS 13, in comparison, had scores of 88.2 fps in Doom 3 and 164.12 fps in Far Cry.

The 4800 mAH battery pack supplied with this laptop sticks out from the rear of this laptop but lasted for a total of 2 hours and 10 min., which is good as we tested it under high performance mode with full brightness.

The ASUS Bamboo U6V is unique. It's compact and weighs 1.57 kg and the performance of this laptop is also good as is the hardware it packs. So if you're looking for something that is light, will make many heads turn and at the same time has some great hardware.

RATINGS

Features	7.5
Performance	8
Build Quality	8
Value for money	5.5
Overall	7.5

